

FCA-Compliant Marketing Content System

Client Guide • Solution Overview & Operating Workflow

Document Purpose	Explain how the solution supports controlled, FCA-aware marketing content creation.
Primary Users	Financial advisers, marketing teams, compliance reviewers and relevant business stakeholders.
Important Note	The system supports compliance processes; it does not replace formal compliance approval or regulated advice.

1. Document Overview

This solution is designed to help financial advisers create FCA-aware marketing content through a controlled and structured workflow. It combines content generation, rule-based compliance review, FCA reference tracking and regulatory change monitoring within a single process.

The platform is intended to support the creation of marketing communications for social media and related digital channels. Content is generated against tracked FCA material and then subjected to an independent validation step before being retained for review and governance.

2. Scope of the Solution

The solution provides five main functional areas:

Content Generation

- Create social media posts and carousel content.
- Select an appropriate product or financial category.
- Add optional campaign, tone, audience or business guidance.

Compliance Grounding

- Track selected FCA Handbook and guidance documents.
- Retrieve and retain current reference text.
- Use relevant regulatory material when generating content.ⁱ

Independent Validation

- Apply a separate compliance review layer to generated content.
- Assess clarity, fairness, balance, risk communication and category suitability.

History and Audit Trail

- Store each generation with relevant metadata.
- Link outputs to date, format, category and regulatory material used.
- Allow historical content to be reviewed for accountability.

Change Detection and Review Flagging

- Identify when a tracked FCA source changes.
- Flag previously generated content that relied on an older source version.
- Support review and regeneration where required.

3. Adviser Operating Workflow

The recommended operating process is:

1. **Select output type:** Choose Post or Carousel.
2. **Select category:** Choose the relevant area, such as Retirement, Investment, Protection, Mortgage, Pension or Lifestyle.
3. **Add campaign guidance:** Optionally provide the campaign theme, product context, marketing objective, tone or audience requirements.
4. **Refresh FCA references:** The system refreshes the tracked FCA reference material.

5. **Generate draft:** The generation engine prepares draft content using the current regulatory material and compliance instructions.
6. **Validate content:** The independent validation layer checks the draft for compliance concerns.
7. **Store approved draft:** If the content passes the configured validation stage, it is stored with its supporting metadata.
8. **Retain regulatory traceability:** The content remains linked to the FCA source snapshot used at generation time.
9. **Monitor regulatory changes:** The system compares current FCA material with previously stored versions.
10. **Review flagged content:** Where a relevant FCA source changes, affected content is flagged for re-checking and, where appropriate, regeneration.

4. Components of the Solution

4.1 Generation Engine

Creates marketing content using the selected category, output format, adviser instructions and current FCA source material. The objective is to produce clear, audience-appropriate and commercially useful content within the applicable financial promotion framework.

4.2 Compliance Monitor

Tracks selected FCA documents and associated guidance. Updated text is retrieved and stored, while a hash is used to detect whether the reference material has changed.

4.3 Validation Layer

Provides an independent review of generated copy. Checks include clarity, fairness, balance, avoidance of misleading statements, category suitability and avoidance of excessive promotional or urgent sales pressure.

4.4 Database and Audit Layer

Stores generated outputs and supporting records, including date and time, category, format, guidance notes, FCA reference snapshot, generated text and status.

4.5 Review and Flagging Workflow

Identifies content that may have been affected by changes to tracked FCA sources and flags it for re-checking or refresh.

5. Client Guidance: Using the System Effectively

- **Provide specific context:** Where possible, describe the campaign objective, intended audience and product context. Better context helps the system produce more relevant drafts.
- **Avoid relying on generated text without review:** Treat generated content as a controlled draft rather than automatically publishable material.
- **Check product-specific details:** Confirm that product names, rates, benefits, eligibility statements and other factual details are accurate before publication.

- **Review risk and limitations:** Ensure that relevant risks, limitations and conditions are presented appropriately alongside benefits.
- **Use the audit trail:** Retain the generated record and regulatory reference information to support internal governance and later review.
- **Act on regulatory flags:** When content is flagged following an FCA source change, review the affected communication before reusing or republishing it.

6. How the Solution Meets Business Requirements

- Client-facing financial marketing content generation
- FCA-aware drafting based on tracked guidance
- Regulatory compliance monitoring
- Independent validation of generated content
- Social media and carousel-ready output formats
- Historical tracking and auditability
- Review handling following regulatory content changes
- Improved operational efficiency for marketing teams
- A controlled workflow connecting generation, validation, storage and review

7. Compliance Considerations

The solution is designed to support communications aligned with relevant FCA principles. Users should consider the following when reviewing any generated marketing material:

- Communication should be clear and understandable.
- Claims should be fair, balanced and supported by appropriate evidence.
- Benefits should not be presented without appropriate consideration of relevant risks or limitations.
- Guaranteed returns, unsupported performance claims and misleading statements should be avoided.
- The intended audience should be able to understand the communication and its implications.
- References to advice, suitability, eligibility or product conditions should be accurate and appropriate.
- Final content should follow the firm's formal compliance sign-off and publication process.

8. Example Client Use Case

A financial adviser wants to prepare a social media post about retirement planning. The adviser selects 'Post', chooses 'Retirement', and enters the campaign objective and target audience. The system refreshes the relevant FCA references, generates a draft, and sends it through the independent validation layer. Once the configured validation requirements are met, the draft and its regulatory reference snapshot are stored. If the relevant FCA source later changes, the system can flag the post for review.

9. Important Limitations and Responsibilities

The platform is intended to support advisers and compliance teams; it should not be treated as a substitute for professional judgement, regulated advice, legal advice or the firm's formal compliance approval process.

- Users remain responsible for verifying factual and product-specific information.
- Compliance teams remain responsible for determining whether content is suitable for publication.
- A detected regulatory change is a review trigger; it does not by itself determine that a particular communication is non-compliant.
- The latest applicable regulatory requirements should be considered before publication.

10. Conclusion

The FCA-Compliant Marketing Content System provides a structured approach to creating, reviewing and monitoring marketing communications for financial advisers. By combining content generation with regulatory grounding, independent validation, auditability and change detection, the solution helps reduce manual effort and improve governance.

The intended outcome is a practical workflow that supports commercial communication while maintaining appropriate regulatory discipline. The system strengthens the organisation's content-control process while keeping final compliance responsibility with the appropriate human reviewers.
